



HUM 104

Functional English

~ Complete Class Notes ~

"It's not about analyzing Shakespeare; it's about using English for practical, real-world communication."

Lectures 1 - 18



🌸 What is Functional English?

Functional = describes/means that something is designed to be practical and useful rather than just theoretical. It's NOT about analyzing Shakespeare — it's about real-world communication.

📅 Constantly Check: (a) Google Classroom (b) MS Teams — all basic info available there



📖 Lecture 1 — Vocabulary & Course Basics



🌸 Vocabulary — Key Terms

Isolated Vocabulary → Looking at words individually — meanings, synonyms, antonyms etc. — rather than just reading a long story

Comprehension Lines → Reading short passages and explaining what they mean

Indexing Protocols → Hints / clues used to decode, decrypt or decipher a message

📖 Think of 'isolated vocabulary' as zooming in on each word like a microscope 🔍 — you study its meaning, synonyms, antonyms separately before using it in a longer text.

🌸 Communication is a 2-Way Process

📧 Sender → enciphers / encodes / encrypts the message (info is shaped into words/language)

📧 Receiver → decodes / decrypts / deciphers the message (info is understood)

📖 Just like sending a WhatsApp Message — you type (encode) and your friend reads (decode).
Communication is always a two-way street! 🌸

✿ Functional English — 2 Vectors (Divisions)

 Active / Productive Vector	 Passive / Receptive Vector
Speaking	Listening (100% passive)
Writing	Reading

✿ Types of Vocabulary

 1. Isolated Morphemes (Words)	 2. Jargons / Integrated Morphemes
Individual standalone words	Specific words used in a specific field
Studied independently	e.g. Medical jargon, Banking jargon
e.g. synonyms, antonyms, meanings	

 Example: Medical: 'myocardial infarction' = heart attack | Banking: 'liquidity ratio'

✿ Course Terminology

Course Face → instead of 'course name'

CDF → Course Description File (instead of 'Course Outline')

Sign in → Clock in

Sign out → Clock out

✿ Terms and Their Meanings

 Latitude → room to breathe

 Thoughts → stream of consciousness

Morpheme = word

✿ How to Write a Date — International Format

 International format: February 6, 2026

Yester-month = last month | Yesterday = the previous day | Yester-year = last year

Write 'Juncture' instead of 'Date'

 Instead of writing 'Date: March 19, 2026' — write 'Juncture: March 19, 2026'

✿ Politically Correct / Inclusive Language

Instead of saying...	Say this instead
Disabled Person	Differently Abled Person
Illegal Immigrants	Undocumented Immigrants
"Nigga"	Diaspora / African Diaspora — a charged morpheme

 Language evolves! Using inclusive terms shows awareness and respect. Words we used 20 years ago may be offensive today — always update your vocabulary. 

6 Ways to Say 'How Are You?'

-  How are you holding up?
-  How is it cracking?
-  How's tricks?
-  What's up? / Sup?
-  Howdy?
-  What it do?

Greetings & Salutations

 Greeting → Salutation

 AVOID: good morning, goodnight, good-noon

 INSTEAD say: GoodDay ✓

 When introducing yourself — use 3rd person pronoun: 'This is...' instead of 'I am...'

 Example: 'This is Albert' — instead of 'I am Albert'

Everyday Useful Phrases

Response to 'Thank you' → 'Sure'

Asking for the bill in a restaurant → 'Can I have the check please?'

500 Rupee note → Bill of 500

Coin = Pentacle (pronounced: Penacle)

"Is she present?" → 'Is she about?'



Lecture 2 — Written Vocab, Prefixes & Pronunciation



Written Vocab — Two Types

 Isolated Morphemes (Words)	 Integrated Morphemes (Jargons)
Standalone words	Field-specific vocabulary
Studied individually	e.g. Medical, Banking, Legal etc.

 3rd Additional Component of written Vocab is "**ideational vocabulary**"

Prefix

Prefix → Any letter(s) added to the root or base word to change its meaning

Bifurcation → Division / splitting into two parts

- ✍️ 'En' prefix: En-route → in the process of / currently happening. Example: 'Are you coming to the party?' — if you're on the way you can say 'Yes, am En-route' (air corridors = roads in the sky)
- ✍️ 'Trans' prefix: Trans-Atlantic (across the Atlantic) | Transgender (across male & female) | Transcription (conversion across script)
- ✍️ 'A' prefix: means not, null → e.g. Amoral (not moral), Atypical (not typical)

✿ Ideational Vocabulary (Advanced Level)

En-route → When asked 'are you en-route?' → 'Yes, am en-route' (in the process / on the way)

Trans → Across

Air Corridors → Roads in the sky

✿ Pronunciation & Accent Standards

BPM → British Posh / British English

BBC English → Standard for foreign students — the benchmark

IPA → International Phonetic Alphabet

26 Alphabets → 44 Phonemes (sounds). Problem: 44 phonemes/sounds for only 26 letters — so pronunciation can NEVER be trusted from spelling alone! IPA solves this by assigning one notation to one sound/graph.

⚠️ **Spelling in English can NEVER be a true guide to pronunciation**

✿ Cultural Vocabulary

USA — 'Melting Pot' → Hybrid culture / amalgamated (mixture) of many cultures

Urban Decay (VIP Morpheme) → A very modern and popular civilization that has been eroded/fallen apart

✿ Denotation vs Connotation ✿

📖 Denotation	💖 Connotation
Dictionary / actual meaning	Emotional / implied meaning
Form-centered	Meaning-centered ✓
The meaning in exaction	Highly subjective — has depth

✍️ Example: 'Urban Decay' — Denotation: a popular city turned into ruins | Connotation: hopelessness, ugly corrupt vectors of society, purity has dissolved

✿ More Key Terms

Organic Person → Very pure / very honest — or blunt: whatever he/she thinks, ak dam moo per bol dena

Double Entendre → Double meaning (Entendre = meaning)

Denouement → Conclusion

Charged Morpheme → Words that are charged — can be positive or negative

Benchmarking → Comparison with the highest in status. Think of it like this: you're setting a 'bench' (a standard/reference point) and measuring yourself against it — comparing to the BEST, not just anyone.

Fringe Benefits → Additional / extra benefit

✿ Interesting Cultural Slang

Karen → Very entitled person (male or female) — thinks the world revolves around them

 Example: 'Gimmi gimmi gimmi, my name is Jimmy' — total Karen energy!

Bye Charlie (males) / Bye Felicia (females) → An insult expression — dismissing someone mid-conversation to make them feel irrelevant

John Doe / Jane Doe → Used when you don't know someone's name — John for male, Jane for female

Nice Nasty → Wrapping insults and presenting them as compliments

Tin Man / Wood Man → A person not having a heart — cruel, cold person

Round Person → High moral standards — jiski borderless approach ho, considers every person equal

✿ Ideation Terminologies ✿

Performativity Principle → Greed / naked self-animalistic interest — looking out for yourself only (apna faida dhekna sirf)

Utilitarianism → Same meaning as Performativity Principle

Symbiosis / Positive Interest → We BOTH benefit — a mutually beneficial relationship

No Symbiosis → Naked self-animalistic approach — same as Performativity Principle

Cost-Benefit Analysis → Calculating benefits and choosing what benefits you the most — lalchi — dosron ki parwah na karna

Talking Circles Around → Batein ghumana — something not fixed / point per na aana

Hoppity Skip → Same as talking circles around — being evasive

Game of Shade & Shadows → Same thing as above

Short Change → Dhoka dena

High Octane Energy → Overly excited / hyper / jazzed up

Jazzed Up → Same as high octane energy

Polar Dichotomy → Conflict — 'you are north pole and I am south pole' — farq kerna among people, ak hierarchy banana

ISA (Ideological System Apparatus) → Institutions that work on an ideology, for example schools

System Arranged → Strict approach, don't like change

System Desarranged → Flexible people — like change, open to new ideas

✿ Profiling, Code Switching & Language Systems

Profiling → Bias and stereotyping — could be both negative or positive — hierarchy banana

Code Switching → Changing the language mid-conversation — like switching from English to Urdu during the same sentence

 Example: Switching between Urdu and English in the same sentence is code switching!

✿ 3 Core Language Analysis Tools

Syntax → Grammar — the rules of how words are arranged

Semantics → Meaning — what the words mean

Morpheme → Word / smallest unit of meaning

✿ IPA — Two Systems in English

 Alphabet System	 Phonetic System (IPA)
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Traditional 26-letter system	International Phonetic Alphabet
Spelling-based	Sound-based
Can mislead pronunciation	Familiarize with IPA chart!

❁ American Vernacular (Hood Language) — 3 Different Names

- **1** Ebonics
- **2** AAVE — African American Vernacular English
- **3** Hoodalogy

📖 Example: 'Run my fay (fade)' = Come and fight with me → This is ragebaiting (trying to provoke a reaction)

❁ Power Dynamics

Overt Dynamics → Visible / out in the open — everyone can see it

Covert Dynamics → Hidden / beneath the surface — concealed

Structure-per-focused = Form-Centered approach | Meaning Centered = Meaning-Centered approach



📖 Lectures 3 & 4 — Literary Lines vs Technical Lines



❁ Literary Lines vs Technical Lines

👤 Literary Lines	⚙️ Technical Lines
Highly subjective	Blunt and plain
Has deep emotional meaning — depth hoti hai	Lack depth
Meaning attached — emotional	Form-centered
"Tis all in the wardrobe" — every bad action is hidden	"Let's issue the reprimand" → alert → warning → in professional settings 3 warnings are issued
"Skeleton in the closet" → dal me khuch to kala ha	"Do you have any documentary evidence?"
"Tis a strange world outside; I'd rather dream owl city" — escapist	"There should not be any terms of endearment" — 'dear' not to be used
"They came wearing masks" — intentions were hidden	"I am trying to factor in that equation" = I am trying to understand what's going on

📖 Literary line: 'I have Macdonald's Ghost' → Jeans culture = modernization → 'I have a ghostly obsession with modernization'

📖 Literary line: 'A clean graveyard is a happy graveyard' — enemy uses this to lure you into danger

📖 Technical line: 'I'm trying to course correct you' = I'm trying to teach you

✿ 'Mad o'What' Concept

Mad o'What → What people say when someone goes against their set of beliefs

📝 You can reply: 'I am not mad, I am just not you.'

✿ Technical Writing — Rules & Tips

✂ Comma Redundancy + Replacement → Remove the comma — it is not needed anymore

📝 Instead of 'Respected Mam,' → Write 'Sir:' and after that in the next line → 'Goodday'

✍ Make your writing TECHNICAL — suit the clientele and see the culture + setting while speaking/writing

✿ Grammar Rules — What NOT to Do

⚠ **Double Positives → NOT to be used (wrong!) — it intensifies incorrectly**

📝 Example: 'Yes, right' / 'Dear and respected mam' → **WRONG** — these are double positives

⚠ **Double Negatives → NOT to be used**

📝 Example: 'I don't have nothing to do with you' → **WRONG** — when 2 morphemes with negative charge are combined = wrong

✿ Honorific Titles in Technical Writing

👤 Title	📋 Meaning
Mrs.	Married female
Miss	Unmarried female
Ms. (pronounced: Miz)	Used to hide marital status
Mr.	Male
Forenoon (F.N.)	In official writing → before noon. Use F.N. in brackets
Brackets	Also called → Brackins

✿ Workplace Communication & Identity

Gendered Language in Context:

Islamabad → Deep City → sab ka apny kaam sy kaam hota ha → Feminine city

Karachi → Masculine city

Receiving on Documents → Responding on documents

📝 Workplace is not always friendly — cooperate means to get along in the workplace setting, not necessarily to be friends. ✿

✿ Self-Introduction for Interviews / Scholarships (Technical Lines)

📋 Personal Statement pages are considered for scholarship abroad

🌱 Represent yourself as an Organic / Round person in your statement

⚖ Technical + Soft — BOTH sides should be present in the personal statement

🎓 First: tell your name + your education + generate a sympathy factor — always — for scholarship

 Add Audio Visual things to your CV

Candidacy → 'A Candidate bringing his candidacy to the interview' → Candidacy means: CV, Resume

Advanced Idiomatic Expressions

Shortchange → Betrayed (Connotation) / Not giving appropriate change (Denotation)

'This is the work of winter smith' → said when something bad happens, done by a very cruel person

'You cannot sit with us' → We are better than you — Us vs Them Hierarchy / Insider vs Outsider

Chatbot of Self in the very oxides of tin → My inner conscious saves me / course corrects me in this cruel world (your moral compass guiding you)

Rank and File of the Office → The people with low ranks — clerks, etc.



Literary Lines — Extended Examples & Analysis



Mundane → Useless / ordinary / dull

1. 'I've measured my life with coffee spoons'

→ I have wasted my life (engaging in useless activities)

 *Coffee spoons are tiny, insignificant things. When someone says this — they are saying: 'I have lived my life in tiny, trivial moments.' They haven't measured their life with big bold experiences — adventures, achievements, revolutions. Mundane = useless / ordinary / dull.*

2. 'Happy clown; itself is the saddest theme of a Carnival'

→ A contrast between what is apparent and what is reality

3. 'We jazz June — we die soon'

→ We enjoy and waste life, and when we realize it's too late. Realization comes at a very late stage.

 *Think of it like this: You're waiting for Eid — you hype it up so much, then Eid comes and you're like 'that's it?' And it's already over. We jazz = we hype ourselves up. June = the thing we were waiting for. We die soon = life passes before we properly felt it.*

4. 'I have boots theory about life'

→ Having boots theory means having a very well-grounded value system. 'Mery morals achy hain so I won't slip in this cruel world and won't be fooled.'

5. 'Running on Broadway in boots'

→ Broadway means life. Boots means good morals / value system. Am living life with a good moral system so I won't slip.

6. 'All animals are equal but some are more equal than others'

'Some' → I am gonna favour certain people over others

Orchestrated a performance → Perception building by faking





✿ (a) English + French Morphemes — Pronunciation Guide

These words come from French, Spanish, German, and Latin but are commonly used in English. Spelling and pronunciation are often VERY different — learn these by heart! 🎧

Word	Pronunciation	Meaning
Antibiotics	ANNA-BIOTICS	Medicines used to kill bacteria
Atlantic	AT-LANIC	The ocean between America, Europe & Africa
Montreal	MON-REAL	A major city in Canada
Illinois	ALLA-NOYE	A state in the United States
Herbs	ERBZ (silent H in American English)	Plants used for flavor or medicine
Advantage	ad-VAN-AGE	A benefit or favorable condition
Identity	eye-DENI-TY	The qualities that make a person unique
Internet	IN-er-net	The global network connecting computers
Asthma	AZ-ma (silent TH)	Medical condition affecting breathing
Treasure	TRAY-YER	Something valuable
Measure	MEAY-YER	To determine size or amount
Pleasure	PLAYEAR	A feeling of happiness or enjoyment
Santa Claus	SANNA-CALUS	Legendary figure who brings gifts on Christmas
Massachusetts	MAYSA-CHEW-SETS	A state in the United States
Missile	MIZZLE	A weapon launched through the air
Mercedes	mer-SAY-deez	A German luxury car brand
Jalapeño	Ya-la-PEN-yo (Halapeno in Pak) y = J in IPA	A spicy Mexican pepper
Volkswagen	VOLKS-vah-gen	A German automobile company
Channel	CHAN-uhl	A medium for communication or broadcasting
Croissant / Kuwasa	kwah-SA	A French buttery pastry
January	JANU-ARY	The first month of the year
October	ok-TOH-ber	The tenth month of the year

Rendezvous	RON-day-vooh	A meeting or appointment
Yves Saint Laurent	EEV san lo-RAHN	Famous French fashion designer & brand
Channel (Brand)	SHAYNELL	French luxury fashion brand

 Rule: In IPA, y = J. So Jalapeño: the J is actually a Y sound.

✿ (b) Isolated Morphemes — Formal/Academic Words

Word	Pronunciation	Meaning
Dormitory	DOR-mi-tor-ee	A residence hall where students live
Caveat	KAY-vee-at	A warning or caution / referential resource
Frosh	FRAWSH	Informal word for a first-year student
Sophomore	SOF-mor	A student in second year of study
Faux Pas	FOH-pah	A social mistake or embarrassing act
WYSIWYG	wiz-ee-wig	'What You See Is What You Get' — print preview / view of entire document
Facsimile	fa-SIM-uh-lee	An exact copy or reproduction of a document
Void ab initio	voyd ab in-ISH-ee-oh	Latin legal term = invalid from the beginning
Ante Meridian (AM)	AN-tee muh-RID-ee-an	Latin = before midday / diameter
Attach hereto	as written	Used for documents that are attached

✿ (c) Integrated Morphemes — Coffee Shop Jargon ☕

Jargon = specialized vocabulary used within a particular profession or community. Coffee shops have their own unique language — knowing it makes you sound like a pro! ☕

Basic Coffee Terms

Word	Pronunciation	Meaning
Barista	buh-REE-stuh	Person who prepares and serves coffee drinks
Decaf	DEE-kaf	Coffee without caffeine
Espresso	es-PRESS-oh	Strong concentrated black coffee
Ristretto	ri-SET-oh	Short, very strong espresso shot
Doppio	DOP-ee-oh	Double shot of espresso
Dirty Coffee	DUR-tee KAW-fee	Espresso added to cold milk

Let's go Dutch	go DUTCH	Each person pays for their own (50/50)
Umami rich	oo-MAH-mee	Burned cheese-like / fishy taste — deep savory flavor
Rich Coffee	—	Thick, creamy, syrup-like texture
Bold Coffee	—	Strong roasted ground bean flavor
Strong Coffee	—	More espresso, less water

Coffee Sizes (Smallest to Largest)

Demitasse → Very small cup — used for espresso

Small → Regular small serving

Grande → Medium size drink

Tall → Large serving size

Venti → Very large size

Trenta → The largest drink size

Types of Coffee

Word	Pronunciation	Meaning
Americano	—	Espresso mixed with hot water
Mocha	—	Espresso with chocolate flavor
Latte	LAH-tay	Espresso mixed with steamed milk
Cappuccino	kap-oo-CHEE-no	Espresso with steamed milk and foam
Macchiato	mah-kee-AH-toh	Espresso topped with milk foam
Red Eye	—	Coffee with espresso added for extra strength
Frappuccino	frap-oo-CHEE-no	Cold blended coffee with milk, ice cream & syrup
Affogato	ah-foh-GAH-toh	Ice cream topped with hot espresso
Panna Cotta	PAN-na KOT-ta	Cream-based Italian dessert, often coffee-flavored
Crème Brûlée	krem broo-LAY	Custard dessert with caramelized sugar on top

Coffee Shop Ordering — Example Expressions

-  'Can I have a tall cappuccino with cinnamon drizzle, please?'
-  'Can I have a grande Americano with cocoa drizzle, please?'
-  'Can I have a venti ristretto with sweetener instead of sugar, please?'
-  'Can I have a decaf latte, please?'
-  'Can I have a venti frappé with two pumps of vanilla syrup, please?'

☞ 'Can I have an iced Americano with vanilla foam and salt flakes, please?'

☞ 'Can I have a flat white with toasted coconut, please?'



Lectures 7 & 8 — Basics of Essay Writing



University-level essays require critical thinking and analytical writing — NOT just description. Always ask: WHY does this matter? HOW does it function? ✍

🌸 17 Rules for Essay Writing 📖

👁 1. Start Unusual — Do NOT always begin with a definition. Start with a powerful question, a short anecdote, a bold academic statement, or an unexpected comparison. Capture attention and stimulate intellectual curiosity.

🎯 2. Write a Clear Thesis Statement — Your essay must clearly state its central argument. It must take a POSITION — not be vague or descriptive. The thesis guides the entire essay structure.

✂ 3. One Paragraph — One Idea — Begin with a topic sentence, expand, provide supporting evidence, conclude the point clearly. Mixing ideas weakens coherence.

🔗 4. Maintain Logical Flow — Ideas should connect smoothly. Use transition words: however, therefore, moreover, in contrast, consequently.

📖 5. Support with References — Academic writing requires evidence. Use books, research articles, reports, credible academic sources. This prevents plagiarism and strengthens credibility.

📖 Example: Creswell, J. W. (2014). | Hyland, K. (2003.) — In-text citation examples

🗨 6. Focus on Analysis, NOT Just Description — Description = what something is. Analysis = WHY it matters and HOW it functions. Analysis demonstrates critical thinking.

🌐 7. Use Interlingual Code-Switching Carefully — Using more than one language can reflect cultural depth, but must be explained clearly and used purposefully.

🌐 8. Adopt an Interdimensional Approach — Examine a topic from multiple perspectives: social, political, psychological, economic, cultural. Prevents oversimplification.

🔗 9. Think Interdisciplinarily — Integrate knowledge from different academic fields. e.g. Climate change → environmental science + economics + ethics + political policy.

⚖ 10. Address Counterarguments — A strong essay anticipates opposing viewpoints. Presenting and responding to counterarguments enhances persuasive power.

🎓 11. Maintain Academic Tone — Avoid slang, emotional exaggeration, informal expressions. Use precise, formal, and measured language.

🔍 12. Write a Strong Conclusion — Do NOT merely repeat the introduction. Synthesize key arguments and provide intellectual closure. May broaden implications or return to the opening idea in a refined manner.

📋 13. Follow the Essay Writing Flowchart — Choose topic → Brainstorm → Thesis statement → Outline → Introduction → Body paragraphs (one idea + evidence + analysis each) → Counterarguments → Conclusion → Proofread.

🗺 14. Add Flowcharts & Arrowheads Where Necessary — It adds to the aesthetic function. e.g. Topic Selection → Thesis Development → Body Paragraphs → Conclusion. Visual mapping supports structured thinking.

📖 15. Use Ideational Vocabulary — Concept-driven, discipline-specific words that express abstract ideas. e.g. 'urban decay'. Strengthens analytical precision and signals intellectual engagement.

🌿 16. Give your essay a Holistic Organic Texture — All parts (intro, thesis, body, evidence, counterarguments, conclusion) must be interconnected and contribute to a unified central argument. They should develop naturally from one another — NOT as isolated sections.

🚫 17. Don't Add Headings — Academic prose essays should NOT have section headings.

🌸 Literary Line Analysis — Part 2 🌸

Figures of speech and charged morphemes make literary lines rich in meaning. Always look for what is HIDDEN beneath the surface! 🌸

1. 'Decadent had something to do with not opening the curtains all day'

Decadent → Rotting or falling apart because of too much luxury or laziness

Curtains → A barrier between you and the real world

Not opening → Choosing to stay in the dark and ignore reality

📖 ⚡ *Charged morphemes: Decadent, not opening, the curtains*

📖 🔗 *Parallel structured lines: 'Game of shade and shadows' / 'its all in the wardrobe' / 'red herring' / 'talking circles around'*

2. 'Tis the work of the Winter Smith'

'Winter Smith' = the harsh environment that hammers and shapes our lives

🏰 This is about rightful blaming — pointing to the 'winter' (hard situation) as the cause

📖 *Symbolic meanings: Ice cream = death and destruction | January = struggle, hardship | Ber-months (November, December) = hardship | Wardrobe = covert dynamics | Pumpkin = destruction*

3. 'They said falling down would be easy if you wear nice comfy shoes'

→ Someone is trying to shortchange you by giving you bad advice or tricking you

→ They lie and say that failing won't hurt if you have 'comfy shoes' (money or status)

→ In reality, they are cheating you out of the truth — falling down ALWAYS hurts, no matter what you wear

4. 'When themes become an urban decay when the town becomes all paper'

Theme → Life itself | Paper → Treating life like a cheap commodity

→ When you reduce the status of life to a cheap commodity → leads to destruction

5. 'Eve arf a brick at me?'

→ 'You bite the hand that feeds you' — betraying someone who helps you

→ The 'brick' represents a sudden, violent attack from someone you may have trusted

6. 'Run my fade' (AAVE)

🗣️ Pronunciation: Run my Fayy | Meaning: I am willing to fight with you / Come fight me

→ This is a ragebaiting / provocation expression

7. 'Rust has become the new colour of the town'

→ Corruption has become the new standard / norm of the town

Rust = charged morpheme symbolizing decay, deterioration, moral corruption

8. 'My shoes are broken down and old yet I hate the shoe stores'

- Represents a rejection of the system
- Even though you are suffering or 'broken,' you hate the 'shoe stores' (authorities or institutional solutions)
- Shows a deep distrust of society — staying broken feels more honest than joining a system you despise

9. 'Time z a null vector hence I burnt my clocks'

'Null vector' = time has no direction and has a value of zero

- Time feels empty and useless — the speaker destroys their clocks to stop caring about it
- Shows a person who has completely given up on the idea of a future or moving forward



Lectures 9 & 10 — Occupational Jargon & Figures of Speech



✿ Part 1 — Occupational / Workplace Jargon

Occupational jargon = specialized vocabulary used in the workplace / professional context. These are important to know for any professional setting! 

Term	Meaning
Red Tape	Unnecessary official procedures / malpractices — gossiping in the office, backbiting, a very negative environment
Rank and File	Common lower-cadre employees — the general workforce
Reprimand	A formal warning
French Leave	Leave without going through proper channel permissions — unannounced leave
NY Minute	Fast-paced stuff — life in New York is very fast-paced
Clock in / Clock out	Sign in / Sign out
Progression	Forward movement
Regression	Opposite of progression — going backwards
Promotion	Moving forward in hierarchy
Demotion	Opposite of promotion — moving down in hierarchy
Postpone	Delayed — pushed to a later time
Prepone	Turning it even earlier / before the original time
Quality Policy	Something that goes through a proper process of check and balance
Ins and Outs	Details — all the specifics of something
Corporate America	Connotatively: Performativity Principle — no job security, red tape environment
Report for Duty	'I am present on duty' — reporting for your shift
Cadre	Ranks

✿ Part 2 — Independent Morphemes

Bespoke → Pronunciation: BISS-pok → Customized items — not ordinary items, made for specific clients

Buyer's Remorse → You buy everything, come home, and feel a sense of guilt/regret. Remorse = regret.

✿ Part 3 — Figures of Speech

We are on the Syntactical part (grammar portion) now. Figures of speech = phrases or morphemes having a DIFFERENT meaning than the literal one. In figures of speech, we use words CONNOTATIVELY.

Fallacy = lies, misconceptions. False arguments — very neatly packaged. Figure of speech = bundle of lies.

CDA = Critical Discourse Analysis — when you critically analyze the meaning of something.

🕸 1. Red Herring

→ A fallacy where irrelevant dimensions are added to divert from the main topic

→ Means: talking circles around — not giving an answer in exaction

🗨 2. Verisimilitude

→ Pronunciation: ver-ih-sim-IL-ih-tood

→ Red herring ka bhai hai — a very polished lie — safeed jhoot

→ Using real-life incidents to create a sense of plausibility to your statement

→ Thora sa real life ka touch dena taakay jhoot zyada realistic or plausible lagey

🔍 3. Oxymoron

→ Combining 2 opposing words together

📝 Example: 'A clean graveyard is a happy graveyard' → oxymoron

🧠 4. Willing Suspension of Disbelief

→ To accept incredible or fictional narratives as real

→ There is a situation totally out of the domain of your intelligence but you still accept it

→ You willingly suspend your good judgement and believe it anyway

🔍 5. Synecdoche

→ Pronunciation: Sin-ik-dochhhh

→ A small part representing / standing in for an entire organic bigger part

📝 Example: 'Wheels' used to mean cars / 'Call ari hai — police waly station mein' → 'call' is a synecdoche for the entire police reporting process

🔊 6. Alliteration

→ The repetition technique — repeating the same initial sound in closely connected words

📝 Example: 'Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers'

★ 7. Hyperbole

→ Pronunciation: Hyper-bali

→ An exaggerated statement — not meant to be taken literally

 Example: 'I've told you a million times!' — hyperbole

✿ Bonus Terms from Class

Bourgeoisie → Pronunciation: Borzouwa — people who HAVE resources / wealthy class

Proletariat → Resources nahin hain — working class with little to no resources

CDA → Critical Discourse Analysis — when you critically analyze the meaning of something



Lectures 11, 12 & 13 — Medical Jargon, Parts of Speech, Tag Questions & Comprehension Rules



✿ Part 1 — Medical Jargon

Remember from Lecture 1 — Jargon = integrated morphemes. These are field-specific words that belong to a particular profession. Today we zoom into the Medical world. 

 Think of it like this: if you walk into a hospital and the doctor starts talking — you better know what they mean. Medical jargon isn't just for doctors — it's useful for every educated person.

Term	Pronunciation / Expansion	Meaning
Comprehensive Management	kom-PREH-hen-siv	A complete, all-around treatment plan for a patient — not just one symptom, but the whole picture
CPR	Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation	An emergency procedure involving chest compressions and rescue breaths to keep blood circulating — used when the heart stops
Resuscitation	ree-SUS-ih-TAY-shun	Reviving someone back to life — bringing them back from the edge
Myocardial Infarction	my-oh-KAR-dee-ul in-FARK-shun	The medical term for a heart attack. 'Myo' = muscle, 'cardial' = heart, 'infarction' = tissue death due to blocked blood supply
Diastole / Systole	DY-as-toh-lee / SIS-toh-lee	Diastole = low BP (heart relaxing). Systole = high BP (heart contracting). High systolic pressure = hypertension
Consultant	kun-SUL-tant	A very senior, highly specialised doctor — the top tier. Not just any GP — the expert called in for difficult cases
GP — General Physician	JEE-PEE	A General Physician — your first point of contact doctor. They treat common illnesses and refer you to specialists when needed
Intravenous (IV)	in-tra-VEE-nus	Into the vein — when medicine or fluids are delivered directly into the bloodstream via a needle/drip. Very common in hospitals

 In real life, when someone says 'the patient needs IV fluids' — they mean fluids going directly into the vein. You'll hear this in any hospital setting.

 Example: 'The consultant advised comprehensive management after the patient's myocardial infarction.'
— This one sentence uses 3 pieces of medical jargon!

✿ Part 2 — Parts of Speech (Syntax / Grammatical Structures)

Syntax = Grammar. Remember this equation — it's been repeated since Lecture 1. Today we break down the 10 building blocks of every English sentence. These are called Parts of Speech.

 Think of it like this: every sentence is a LEGO structure. Parts of speech are the different shaped LEGO pieces — you need to know what each one does before you can build something. 

Part of Speech	Definition	Example
Noun	The name of a person, place, or thing	Ahmed, Islamabad, chair, freedom
Verb	A word describing an action or state	running, is, writes, laughed
Adverb	Qualifies / modifies a verb — tells us HOW, WHEN, WHERE	quickly, very, yesterday, here
Adjective	Qualifies / modifies a noun — tells us WHAT KIND	beautiful, tall, red, intelligent
Conjunction	Joining words — they connect clauses or words	so, until, because, yet, therefore, moreover, since
Interjection	Express strong emotions — often followed by '!'	Hurrah! Well! Aha! Bravo! Ouch!
Pronoun	Replaces the name of a person, place or thing	she (for Sara), they, him, we, it
Preposition	Used before a noun/pronoun to show place, time, direction	at, in, on, above, below, from, under
Article	Specifies or introduces a noun	a, an, the
Numeral	Indicates number or quantity	one, first, double, twice

 **Adverb qualifies a VERB. Adjective qualifies a NOUN. Students always mix these two up — don't.**

 Example: 'She ran quickly to the beautiful garden.' — 'quickly' = adverb (modifies ran) | 'beautiful' = adjective (modifies garden)

✿ 2 Approaches to Learning Grammar

App 1 → Deductive Approach + GTM	App 2 → Inductive Approach + Total Immersion
GTM = Grammar Translation Method	Total Immersion = You are thrown into the language without explicit grammar rules
Rules are taught FIRST, then examples	You learn by DOING — exposure, listening, speaking
Traditional classroom approach	Like a child learning their mother tongue
More structured and analytical	More natural and organic — sink or swim approach

 Think of it like this: GTM = someone teaches you the recipe first. Total Immersion = you are put inside a kitchen and expected to cook. Both work — depending on the learner.

✿ Part 3 — Tag Questions

Definition: A tag question is a construction where a short interrogative fragment is added at the END of a statement to turn it into a question.

 Think of it like this: you make a statement, but then you add a little 'checking' tail at the end — you're asking for confirmation or agreement. Like how in Urdu we say 'hai na?' at the end of a sentence. That's exactly a tag question. ✿

Rules for Tag Questions

1. If the main clause is POSITIVE → the tag must be NEGATIVE
2. If the main clause is NEGATIVE → the tag must be POSITIVE
3. The tag must use the SAME auxiliary verb as the main clause
4. The tag uses a PRONOUN — never repeats the noun

Main Clause (Statement)	Tag Question
She is a doctor.	Isn't she?
Yesterday was so much fun,	wasn't it?
They have finished the work,	haven't they?
You can speak French,	can't you?
He wasn't there,	was he?
We don't have class tomorrow,	do we?

 'Yesterday was so much fun, wasn't it?' — the main clause is positive ('was fun') so the tag is negative ('wasn't it'). Easy rule — just flip it!

✿ Part 4 — Comprehension Passage Rules

Comprehension = understanding what you read. In exams and professional settings, you'll often be given a passage and asked questions about it. These are the 10 rules to crack it every time. 

 **Remember from Lecture 1: Comprehension Lines = reading short passages and explaining what they mean.**

1. Do NOT over-emphasize trivialities

 Don't lose time and energy on small details. Focus on the BIG picture — the main argument.

2. Do NOT get stuck in a writer's block situation

 If you blank out, move on. Come back. Don't stare at the page. The brain unfreezes when you keep moving.

3. Do NOT read the passage first — try detecting the VIBE

 Before reading word by word — skim for the emotional tone. Is the passage positive or negative? Optimistic or critical? This gives you a compass before you go deep.

4. Do NOT over-emphasize vocabulary — don't focus on every single morpheme

 *You don't need to understand every single word. Look for meaning in context. Think of it like driving — you don't stare at every pebble on the road.*

5. Do NOT spend time on lines you cannot comprehend at first

 *If a line confuses you, skip it for now. Return after you have the overall picture. Context often solves what isolated reading cannot.*

6. Skim the passage BEFORE scanning

Skimming	Scanning
Reading quickly to get the GENERAL idea	Reading carefully to find SPECIFIC information
First pass — fast and loose	Second pass — targeted and precise
Like watching a movie trailer	Like finding a specific scene in the movie

7. Do NOT rely on 'trigger words' — try finding CAVEAT WORDS instead

 *Trigger words are obvious. Caveat words are the hidden qualifiers — words like 'however', 'unless', 'despite', 'although' — these are where the REAL meaning changes.*

 *Example: 'The economy improved, however inequality grew.' — 'however' is the caveat word. The real message is about inequality — not improvement.*

8. Write the answers in YOUR OWN WORDS

 *Copy-pasting from the passage is NOT comprehension. It shows you can read, not that you understood. Paraphrase. Restructure. Show thinking.*

9. Do NOT use headings in your answers

 *Comprehension answers should be in flowing prose — not structured with bold headings. Keep it natural and clean.*

10. Read the passage AGAIN at the end for errors

 *Your last read should be a proofread — check your own answers for grammar, meaning, and completeness.*



Lectures 14, 15 & 16 — Restaurant Jargon & Food Culture



Part 1 — Restaurant Expressions

Just like we did with Coffee Shop Jargon in Lectures 5 & 6 — today we go into Restaurant jargon. Real-life, practical English you actually USE when dining out.

 *Think of it like this: walking into a restaurant and knowing exactly what to say — that's functional English in action.* 

Expression	What it means / When to use it
A table for two, please	When you arrive and need seating for 2 people

Yes, we do have a reservation	Confirming a booking you made earlier
Could you bring me the menu, please?	Politely asking the server for the menu
Can I get a refill of soda without ice, please?	Asking to top up your drink — 'refill' = same drink topped up again
Can I get a California almonds and a blue mocktail?	Ordering snacks + a non-alcoholic cocktail — mocktail = mock (fake) cocktail
Can I get a cheeseburger with a side of onion rings?	'Side' = extra item on the side — not the main dish
I'm stuffed	Very casual way of saying 'I am completely full' — cannot eat anymore
I'm Hank Marvin	British slang / rhyming slang for 'starving' — I am very hungry
Will the order be for here or to go?	Server asking: are you eating IN the restaurant or taking it away?
For here, please / To go, please	Your answer to the above question
Anything else for you today?	Server asking if you want to add more to your order
No thanks, I'm good	Polite way of saying no — you're satisfied
Would you go for a buffet or à la carte?	Buffet = fixed price, variety of dishes À la carte = you order individual items from the menu (by the card)

❁ Part 2 — Restaurant & Food Vocabulary

Word / Term	Pronunciation	Meaning
Condiments	KON-dih-ments	Sauces and spices added to food — ketchup, mustard, chilli sauce etc.
Froyo	FROH-yoh	Frozen yogurt — a dessert blend between ice cream and yogurt
Brinner	BRIN-er	Breakfast + Dinner combined — eaten at dinner time but with breakfast items
Spork	SPORK	Spoon + Fork combined — a utensil that is both at once
Coleslaw	KOHL-slaw	A salad made from shredded cabbage — usually served as a side dish
Let's go Dutch	—	Each person pays for their own share — 50/50 split. (Also in Coffee Jargon — connecting the dots!)
Beverages	BEV-er-ij-ez	All types of drinks — hot, cold, alcoholic, non-alcoholic, sherbets etc.
Refuse	REF-yoos (noun)	In restaurant context, refuse = waste / garbage. NOT 'to refuse' (verb).

Doggy Bag	DOG-ee bag	A bag for leftover food that you take home — the food you couldn't finish
Wok Kitchen	WOK kitch-en	A kitchen style centered around a wok (large pan) — typically Asian cuisine
Spice Kitchen	—	A kitchen focused on bold, spiced dishes — heavy use of seasoning
Cuisine	kwih-ZEEN	Culture-specific food — Italian cuisine, Pakistani cuisine etc.
Staple Food	STAY-pul	Frequently used / basic food of a culture — for Pakistanis: roti and rice are staple foods
Hash Browns	HASH brownz	Fried grated potato patties — also called cutlets in some regions
Crisps vs Fries	—	Crisps = thin potato chips (British English) Fries = fried potato sticks (American English)
Spuds	SPUDZ	Informal/slang word for potatoes
Tortilla	tor-TEE-ya (Spanish)	A thin flatbread — used in Mexican cuisine for wraps
Bagel	BAY-gul	A bread roll — round with a hole in the middle, often dense and chewy
Burrito	buh-REE-toh	A Mexican wrap filled with meat, beans, rice and cheese
Taco	TAH-koh	A Mexican folded bread with filling — similar concept to a shawarma
Doritos	doh-REE-toz	A brand of flavored triangle-shaped chips — commonly eaten as a snack
Charcuterie Board	shar-KOO-tuh-ree	An appetizer board — cold cuts, cheeses, fruits, crackers. Note: 'Ch' is pronounced like 'Sh' in French
Croissant	kwah-SAH (French)	A buttery, flaky puff pastry — crescent shaped. Already covered in Lectures 5 & 6
Tapas	TAP-as	Small appetizer plates — Spanish in origin. You order many small dishes to share
Misters	—	Air purifiers / machines that control air quality in the restaurant — reduce pollutants

🌸 Meal Times — Extended Vocabulary

English has more names for meals than just breakfast, lunch, and dinner! 📺

Term	Meaning
Breakfast	First meal of the day — typically morning
Brunch	Breakfast + Lunch — eaten mid-morning. Too late for breakfast, too early for lunch

Lunch	Midday meal
Brinner	Breakfast + Dinner — dinner time but with breakfast food (already covered above)
Dinner	Evening meal — the main meal of the day

✿ Taste Vocabulary — How to Describe Food Professionally

When eating out, knowing how to describe taste makes you sound educated and aware. Don't just say 'it's nice' — use the right word! 🍴

Term	What it Tastes Like
Savoury	Spicy / salty / richly flavoured — not sweet
Tangy	Strong, acidic, sharp flavour — like lemon or tamarind (imli)
Umami Rich	Burned cheese-like or deep savory flavour — already in Coffee Jargon notes
Bitter	Sharp, unpleasant edge — like black coffee or dark chocolate
Sweet	Sugary flavour — desserts, syrups, honey
Punchy	Intense, sharp flavour that hits you — like raw garlic or strong spices

📝 Example: 'This coffee is quite punchy — must be extra garlic in the rub?' or 'The sauce was tangy — very sharp on the tongue.'



📖 Lectures 17 & 18 — Technical / Formal Writing: FBR (Feasibility Business Report)



✿ Introduction — What is an FBR?

FBR = Feasibility Business Report. This is one of the most important pieces of professional / technical writing you will ever produce. It is NOT an essay — it is a formal document that argues for or against a project based on EVIDENCE.

📝 Think of it like this: imagine you want to build something or start a project in your office or university. Before anyone gives you money or permission — you need to PROVE it's doable. That proof document is the FBR. 📋

Feasibility → Is this project actually POSSIBLE and PRACTICAL?

Business Report → Formal documentation — structured, evidence-based, professional

✿ The 4 IPs — Gauging Matrices of an FBR

An FBR checks a project through 4 distinct lenses — called IPs (Implementation Parameters or Investigation Points). Each IP answers a different question about whether the project is viable.

 Think of it like this: before you build a house, you check 4 things — Is it legal? Will people like it? Can you afford it? Do you have the materials? That's exactly what the 4 IPs do. 

IP 1 — Legal Feasibility	IP 2 — Behavioral Feasibility
Does this project violate any law or policy?	Will people actually use/benefit from this?
Are there any legal ramifications or restrictions?	Does it contribute to personality, grooming, social networking or ethics?
If it's an internal organizational decision — no legal barrier exists	Human behavior + psychology is checked here

IP 3 — Financial Feasibility	IP 4 — Technical Feasibility
Can we afford this?	Do we have the technical resources?
Is there budget — internal or external?	Equipment, IT, infrastructure, furniture, manpower?
Who covers the cost — accounts dept, grant, fundraising?	What % is already available? What needs to be arranged?

✿ Full Sample FBR — Step by Step

Below is the complete model FBR from class — annotated with what each section means and why it's written that way. Study the FORMAT, not just the content. 

— HEADER BLOCK —

Mr. John Doe
Incharge, MRC
Comats University
Islamabad, 45550
Juncture: October 9, 2024

 Use 'Juncture' instead of 'Date' — as taught from Lecture 1. And 'John Doe' is used because from Lecture 2: John Doe = name used when a specific person is not yet identified.

— TITLE —

FBR for Common Room

 The title should be short, direct, and clearly state what the FBR is about. No vague language.

— PROBLEM STATEMENT —

There is no common room available for students of the Electrical Engineering department.

What is a Problem Statement? → A problem statement is ONE or TWO lines that clearly identify the issue this FBR is addressing. It is the reason this document exists.

 Keep it blunt and technical. No emotional language. No 'I feel that...' — just the facts.

— EXECUTIVE SUMMARY —

The feasibility of construction was checked across varying gauging matrices of the 4 distinct IPs of the FBR as follows.

What is an Executive Summary? → A brief overview of what the entire report covers — written for a senior person (executive) who may not read every detail.

 *Think of it like a movie trailer — you tell them enough to understand the structure without giving everything away. Executives are BUSY — keep the summary tight and clean.*

— FIRST IP: LEGAL FEASIBILITY —

The project faces no legal ramifications and is an organization's internal decision.

No legal ramifications → No laws are broken. No external authority needs to be involved.

Internal decision → This falls within the organization's own authority to approve or reject.

 *Always address whether legal permission is needed from outside. If it's internal — state that clearly. If it needs government/legal clearance — that would be a legal barrier.*

— SECOND IP: BEHAVIORAL FEASIBILITY —

The project is liable to add to the personality development, grooming, social networking, and ethics of students.

Personality development → A common room gives students space to grow socially and professionally

Grooming → Social skills, presentation, interaction — all happen in common rooms

Social networking → Students from different departments meeting and connecting

Ethics → Shared spaces teach respect, responsibility, and collective ownership

 *Behavioral feasibility = will people USE it and BENEFIT from it? Always tie it back to human development. This is where you show the project adds value beyond just a physical space.*

— THIRD IP: FINANCIAL FEASIBILITY —

The project would be covered using internal budget arrangements by the accounts department.

Internal budget → Money already exists within the organization — no need for external funding or loans

Accounts department → The responsible body that would manage and release the funds

 *If external funding is needed — that complicates financial feasibility. Internal budget = simpler, faster. Always identify the source of money clearly.*

— FOURTH IP: TECHNICAL FEASIBILITY —

50% of technical support is already available in the form of furniture and IT facilities. The remaining 50% can be arranged within a timeline of one month.

50% already available → Half the work is done — furniture, computers, basic infrastructure exists

50% within one month → The rest is achievable in a clear, stated timeline — this shows planning

 *Technical feasibility must always include: what's already there AND what still needs to be arranged AND by when. Vague answers here weaken the FBR.*

✿ Contingency & Mitigation

After the 4 IPs, a strong FBR also includes a Contingency Plan — meaning: what is our BACKUP if something goes wrong?

Contingency → A backup plan — what happens if Plan A fails?

Mitigation → Steps taken to REDUCE risk — making problems less likely or less damaging

Example Contingency Flowchart:

Project Delayed due to Budget Freeze

- Activate emergency internal fund allocation
- Communicate revised timeline to stakeholders
- Resume construction under updated schedule

 *Flowcharts make contingency plans visual and easy to follow. Always include them in a real FBR submission — as taught in the essay writing rules (Lecture 7/8, Rule 14).*

✿ FBR — Key Vocabulary

Term	Meaning
Feasibility	The state of being possible or achievable — can this actually be done?
Ramification	A consequence or complication — usually negative. 'No legal ramifications' = no legal consequences
Gauging Matrices	Measurement frameworks — the lenses/criteria used to evaluate the project
Executive Summary	A short, high-level overview written for senior decision-makers (executives)
Problem Statement	A clear, concise statement identifying the specific issue the report addresses
IP (Investigation Point)	Each of the 4 areas checked in the FBR — Legal, Behavioral, Financial, Technical
Timeline	A defined period within which something must be completed
Contingency	A backup plan for unexpected events or failures
Mitigation	Reducing the likelihood or impact of a risk
Through Proper Channel	Submitting via the official hierarchy — not bypassing management (from Lectures 9/10)
Stakeholders	Anyone who has an interest or is affected by the outcome of the project

✿ FBR vs Essay — Quick Comparison

FBR (Feasibility Business Report)	Essay (Academic Writing)
Technical and blunt	Academic and analytical
Structured under IPs	Structured under thesis + body + conclusion
Evidence = data, budgets, timelines	Evidence = citations, references, research
Written for executives / decision-makers	Written for academic audience
No emotional language	Analytical tone — but can be argumentative
IPs are formal sections	No headings in body paragraphs



✿ End of HUM104 Notes — Lectures 1-18 ✿

Complete Class Notes

